

BEGINNER SETUP GUIDE

MarkItDown MCP for Claude Desktop.

Cut PDF token usage by up to 70%. Connect Microsoft's MarkItDown MCP so every uploaded file converts to clean Markdown automatically.

[INSTALLATION SEQUENCE]

01

Install Python 3.10 or newer

Download from python.org and run the installer. On Windows, tick "Add Python to PATH" during setup.

02

Open your terminal

Mac: open the Terminal app. Windows: open Command Prompt.

03

Install the uv package manager

Paste the command for your OS and press Enter.

MAC / LINUX

```
curl -LsSf https://astral.sh/uv/install.sh | sh
```

WINDOWS (POWERSHELL)

```
powershell -c "irm https://astral.sh/uv/install.ps1 | iex"
```

04

Open Claude Desktop → Settings → Developer

Click the Claude menu (top-left), open Settings, then go to the Developer tab in the sidebar.

05

Click Edit Config and paste this exact block

Replace any existing text in the config file with the JSON below, then save and close.

CLAUDE_DESKTOP_CONFIG.JSON

```
{"mcpServers":{"markitdown":{"command":"uvx","args":["markitdown-mcp"]}}}
```

06

Quit Claude Desktop, then reopen it

Fully quit the app (not just close the window) and launch it again so it picks up the new MCP server.

07

Test it — upload a PDF or Word doc

Drop a file into the chat. MarkItDown converts it to clean Markdown before Claude reads it. Done.

70%

TOKEN REDUCTION

110K+

GITHUB STARS

ALL

FILE TYPES SUPPORTED

That's it. Every file you upload now arrives as clean Markdown.

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